Chet Aldrich

Software Engineer

(+1) 641-780-8874 | chetaldrich@gmail.com | chetaldrich.com | github.com/chetaldrich | linkedin.com/in/chetaldrich

Summary

Engineering leader who has personally driven tens of millions of dollars in incremental revenue and millions in annual profit impact across insurance, e-commerce, and on-demand delivery. Promoted through multiple engineering roles at Root Insurance and Postmates by combining technical strategy, cross-functional influence, and product sense to ship real, useful software to millions of customers.

Work Experience

Root Insurance

Remote

Senior Staff Software Engineer — *Mar 2024 - Present*

- Redeveloped Root's interview process and leveling guide used to hire individual contributors across the engineering organization, stewarding a process that has doubled headcount with consistently strong candidate feedback.
- Drove adoption of AI coding tools across Engineering and Data Science, piloting GitHub Copilot and navigating procurement, infosec, and training hurdles in 2024, then running roadshows for OpenAI Codex in late 2025 including demonstrations of mass refactoring.
- Identified and mitigated multiple critical security incidents as the direct point of contact for responsible disclosure, producing proofs of concept, deploying emergency patches, and coordinating external audits.
- Orchestrated PCI 4.0.1 compliance including change management (6.4.3) and file integrity monitoring (11.6.1), and provided guidance and auditor walkthroughs for Sarbanes-Oxley compliance.
- Selected by the CTO to join executive leadership (CEO, SVP Business Development, VP Product) in crafting a strategic proposal for a major partnership, where technical framing directly influenced the company's proposal.
- Made the case for and led the split of billing from policy management, completing the transition to three dedicated teams (legal document generation, policy management, and billing). Partnered with my manager to interview and onboard new engineers.
- Established an org-wide design review process; mentored engineers through promotions from Software Engineer 1 to Senior and Senior to Lead, and onboarded two Staff engineers to the organization.

Staff Software Engineer — *Nov 2022 - Mar 2024*

- Designed and led the development of a system allowing the business to configure fee revenue by market in coordination with two other engineering teams, allowing Root to collect an incremental $31 million a year in revenue not subject to premium taxation or reinsurance cost.
- Led the development of GUARD-EB, a system that adjusts customer down payments via a machine learning model, generating a 0.5% loss ratio impact ($4.5M annual profit) and giving Data Science a significant lever for managing new writings growth.
- Consolidated billing from policy-term-level to account-level to enable early renewal payments, driving an estimated 0.68% net retention uplift across the book of business.
- Identified and designed a self-service documents system to remove engineering from the critical path for legal document changes, championing the initiative and making the case for and leading the split into a dedicated team.
- Steered the team through significant leadership churn, including two quarters without a manager, taking responsibility for quarterly planning, project prioritization, and cross-functional coordination to consistently deliver business-critical initiatives.

Senior Software Engineer — *Oct 2021 - Nov 2022*

- Designed, built, and deployed a customer profile storage system. This service reduced read load on the monolith's primary database by about 20% and afforded new use cases, such as employing the customer profile for use in automated underwriting decisions and pricing analysis workflows.
- Moved the company's monitoring and alerting infrastructure from Grafana to Datadog, saving the company about $100k a year.

Amazon

Remote

Software Development Engineer — *Apr. 2020 - Aug. 2021*

- Led a project generalizing an application used for handling support issues for Amazon sellers to also be used for vendors, deprecating a redundant system and internationalizing the application to allow it to serve eight new countries, including some with RTL and logographic languages.
- Partnered with Product to define the international seller support experience, leading a program that globalized Seller Central's customer support across three projects covering issue discovery, help content search, and case creation and transfer, ensuring a consistent localized experience for sellers operating across multiple countries.

Postmates

Remote

Senior Software Engineer

Sep 2019 - Apr 2020

- Built and released an inventory management system for the Postmates integration with Google Search, Maps, and the Assistant. Also was responsible for ongoing development of the integration, which grew to generate an incremental $72 million in yearly revenue.
- Led my team's migration from AWS to GCP, establishing IAM policies and Terraform patterns adopted by the Buyer team.
- Built common libraries to simplify data processing and I/O in Apache Beam, adopted by four teams across the company.

Software Engineer II

Feb 2018 - Sep 2019

- Expanded the search API to include local product search, product search within menus/catalogs, and search suggestions, coordinating with client engineers from three platforms (Android, iOS, Web) to consume the new API.
- As a core contributor to the data pipeline behind the Postmates feed, drove optimizations that led to a 1.5% increase in deliveries, a 2% increase in first-time jobs, and a reduction in average drop-off distance across all deliveries.
- Built the initial infrastructure for classifying customers, which became the basis for personalization of the app experience.
- Built tooling to simplify creation of new search indices, used to power a customer support search service and a place-matching service that replaced a Foursquare-based ingestion system with a data pipeline for importing new locations.

Software Engineer

Sep 2017 - Feb 2018

- Rebuilt search from the ground up, moving from a third-party solution to a solution with incremental search for restaurants and an adjustable internal ranking algorithm.

Pandora

Oakland, CA

Software Engineer

Aug. 2016 - Aug. 2017

- Built a MapReduce pipeline to estimate reach and frequency for ad campaigns which decreased forecast runtime by 37 percent.
- Built automated reporting jobs to identify trending artist messages and featured tracks for the Music Makers team.
- Created tools to help artists identify regional variations in popularity of their songs.
- Returned as a full-time engineer after a 2015 internship with the company.

Education

Carleton College

Northfield, MN

B.A. Computer Science

Sep. 2012 - Jun. 2016

- Rewarded distinction in the major for outstanding work in the senior integrative exercise.

Skills

Languages	Python, Ruby, Scala, Java, Go, Rust
Frameworks	Ruby on Rails, Apache Beam
Deployment Platforms	AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes
Databases	Postgres, DynamoDB, Bigtable/HBase
Tools	Git, Docker, Terraform, Datadog, Vim, LaTeX